

Thursday, 10 September 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON

Light drizzle

20° 13°

BIRMINGHAM

Overcast

18° 12°

MANCHESTER

Light drizzle

18° 11°

GLASGOW

Drizzle

16° 13°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

- 1 **The Prime Minister says he'll fund defence and cut the welfare bill 'the Labour way', as a senior politician warns national security can't come at the expense of social security.**

Andy Burnham, the Mayor of Greater Manchester, has spoken out as the government outlines its plans. This is a key policy area for the current administration.

POLITICS · UK

- 2 **Channel 4 is set to cut 340 jobs by the end of the year as part of a major shake-up, following a review of the network.**

The broadcaster says the decision comes amid a "rapidly changing media landscape." It's a significant restructure for the channel.

MEDIA · UK

- 3 **Thousands of teenagers are missing out on education 'under the radar' of official statistics, according to a new report from the children's commissioner for England.**

Many are enrolled at college but simply aren't showing up, meaning their absence isn't always recorded. It raises concerns about young people's future opportunities.

EDUCATION · UK

- 4 **Four women have waived their anonymity to speak out about being raped and exploited by a drug gang as teenagers, in a new documentary.**

They've bravely shared their stories for 'Britain's Forgotten Girls', detailing how they were targeted by criminals when they were children. It's a shocking and important insight.

CRIME · UK

- 5 **The chief of the RNLI says volunteers are facing "unacceptable" abuse, with "deliberate misinformation" being spread about the charity.**

Peter Sparkes has spoken out about the challenges faced by the lifeboat crews. The RNLI relies on public support and donations for its vital work.

CHARITY · UK

What's coming up

- 1 Glastonbury has confirmed its ticket sale dates for next year – and the price has hit a new high, topping £400 for the first time.**

The iconic festival will return in June after taking a fallow year. Fans will need to be quick off the mark to secure their spot.

ON AIR – Are you planning to try and get tickets for Glastonbury next year, or is the price just too much now?

MUSIC · COMING UP
- 2 Nigella Lawson is being praised as the new judge on the latest series of Bake Off, with the new contestants also announced.**

The TV chef joins the show for its 17th series, and a fresh crop of hopefuls are ready to battle it out to be crowned star baker. It's always a highlight of the TV calendar!

ON AIR – What do you think of Nigella joining Bake Off? And are you excited for the new series?

TV · COMING UP
- 3 Monty Don is set to leave Gardeners' World after more than 20 years at the helm, saying "now is the right time for a change."**

The much-loved presenter has described his time on the show as "deeply rewarding." He'll certainly be missed by gardening enthusiasts.

ON AIR – Will you miss Monty Don on Gardeners' World? Who do you think should take over?

TV · FUTURE
- 4 Alan Carr held back tears on a special night at the National Television Awards, where he and 'Celebrity Traitors' both picked up big wins.**

It was the 26th edition of the awards, celebrating the best of British television. Alan's win was clearly a very emotional moment for him.

ON AIR – Did you watch the National Television Awards? What was your favourite moment, or who were you rooting for?

TV · AWARDS
- 5 A former Dallas Cowboys Cheerleader has impressed on Broadway, overcoming criticism of 'stunt casting' for her debut in 'Chicago'.**

She's proved her critics wrong, showcasing her talent on stage. It sounds like a fantastic performance!

ON AIR – Have you ever seen a celebrity in a stage show where you weren't sure what to expect, but they completely blew you away?

THEATRE · NOW

On the schedule

1 **England have demolished Pakistan to take charge of the third Test at Edgbaston, moving on course for a 3-0 clean sweep.**

The home side dominated on the opening day, bowling out Pakistan for a dismal 133. England closed on 156-4, already with a lead of 23.

ON AIR – What a start for England! Do you think they'll secure that 3-0 series win today?

CRICKET · UK

2 **Great Britain's Matthew Brennan has continued his remarkable Grand Tour debut, sprinting to a fifth stage victory at the Vuelta a Espana.**

Brennan's incredible form in Seville means he's now secured five stage wins in this year's race. What an achievement for the British rider!

ON AIR – Five stage wins is incredible! Is Matthew Brennan a name we'll be hearing a lot more of in cycling?

CYCLING · NOW

3 **Josh Kerr says he's "very happy" to see Jakob Ingebrigtsen back competing, but insists he's "not going to lose" when their rivalry resumes this weekend.**

Kerr was responding to criticism, stating he's "not a robot" ahead of their highly anticipated reunion. It promises to be an exciting race!

ON AIR – Who are you backing this weekend in the big Josh Kerr vs Jakob Ingebrigtsen showdown?

ATHLETICS · COMING UP

4 **Ben Shelton has reached the US Open semi-finals after beating Carlos Alcaraz in a thrilling five-set epic that finished in the early hours.**

It was a gruelling match that went on until 3:34 AM local time. Shelton's victory is a huge upset at the tournament.

ON AIR – Staying up until the early hours for a tennis match – worth it or not? Have you ever done it?

TENNIS · NOW

5 **Jose Mourinho says Trent Alexander-Arnold is "not a midfielder" despite starting him there for Real Madrid's win over Inter Milan.**

The England international played in the middle for the Champions League clash. Mourinho's comments suggest he sees Alexander-Arnold's future elsewhere.

ON AIR – Is Trent Alexander-Arnold a midfielder, or is his best position still in defence? What do you think?

FOOTBALL · UK

Quick hits

- 1 A new study reveals that listening to the gentle rumble of a washing machine can be surprisingly soothing.**
Researchers suggest the rhythmic, consistent sound provides a comforting background noise, helping some people relax or even concentrate better. It's the new white noise!
- 2 Gardeners are discovering the unexpected joy of talking to their houseplants, claiming it helps them thrive.**
While scientific proof is still debated, many green-fingered enthusiasts believe a friendly chat and a bit of positive affirmation makes their ferns and ficuses flourish. Perhaps it's the carbon dioxide!
- 3 The charming tradition of 'library card art' is quietly growing, with people creating miniature masterpieces on their library cards.**
From tiny landscapes to whimsical characters, these personalised cards are turning a practical item into a unique form of self-expression. It's certainly one way to make sure you don't lose it!
- 4 A fascinating report highlights the rise in popularity of 'community bird feeder networks' in urban areas.**
Neighbours are collaborating to ensure local birds have a consistent food supply, creating designated feeding stations and sharing responsibility. It's a lovely way to connect with both nature and each other.
- 5 More people are embracing the quaint hobby of 'collecting old cinema ticket stubs' as mementos.**
Each stub tells a story of a film seen, a moment shared, and a memory made, offering a nostalgic look back at cinematic experiences. Some even frame them!
- 6 A delightful trend shows an increase in 'picnic blanket appreciation societies' across the country.**
Members share tips on the best picnic spots, favourite blanket patterns, and, of course, delicious recipes for al fresco dining. It's all about celebrating the simple joys of outdoor eating.
- 7 The humble act of 'leaving anonymous positive sticky notes' in public places is spreading small smiles and cheer.**
People are writing encouraging messages and leaving them on bus stops, park benches, or library books for strangers to discover. A little bit of kindness can go a long way.

05 – TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to secretly 'doing' what when we're trying to quickly judge if a new brand of cereal will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific?

ANSWER: LOOKING AT THE PICTURE ON THE BOX AND DECIDING IF THE ANIMATED CHARACTER LOOKS 'FRIENDLY' ENOUGH.

Q Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to having a particular 'odd habit' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, hot cup of tea, especially if it's a new blend. What is it?

ANSWER: SMELLING THE DRY TEABAG AT LEAST THREE TIMES, VERY DEEPLY, TO 'GAUGE ITS POTENTIAL'.

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday sound' can just make you feel instantly happy or bring a smile to your face, even if it's something really ordinary?**
What's that one surprising sound that always brightens your day, from the 'clink' of ice in a drink to the 'purr' of a happy cat, and why does it make you smile?

- **We all have that 'one household item' that we've had for ages, which might not be fancy, but it just brings you joy or makes your daily routine a little bit easier, don't we?**
What's that unsung hero in your home – perhaps a trusty old mug, a well-loved chopping board, or a quirky kitchen gadget – and why is it so special to you?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY – LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **History.** Did you know that the Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to stop the Great Plague, as it destroyed many of the rat-infested buildings?

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The first ever recorded 'thumbs up' gesture was used by Roman emperors to indicate that a gladiator should be spared after a fight.

06 – LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£95 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£95 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 – FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of owls is called a parliament.
- The human eye can distinguish about 10 million different colours.
- Butterflies taste with their feet.
- It is impossible for most people to lick their own elbow.
- The world's oldest known living tree is over 5,000 years old.
- A bolt of lightning is five times hotter than the surface of the sun.
- Ostriches can run faster than horses.
- The shortest complete sentence in the English language is 'Go!'

On this day

Day 253 of the year, 112 days left in 2026. Today Amerindian Heritage Day (Guyana); Children's Day (Honduras); Christian feast day: Alexander Crummell (Episcopal Church); Christian feast day: Ambrose Barlow. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1955 — Pat Mastelotto, American rock drummer
- 1968 — Big Daddy Kane, American rapper, producer, and actor
- 1998 — Sheck Wes, American rapper
- 1931 — Philip Baker Hall, American actor (died 2022)
- 1989 — Matt Ritchie, English footballer
- 2004 — Gabriel Bateman, American actor[citation needed]
- 1932 — Bo Goldman, American playwright, screenwriter, and producer (died 2023)
- 1958 — Siobhan Fahey, Irish singer-songwriter and producer

THE DAY TODAY

- 1961 — A President Airlines Douglas DC-6 crashes just after takeoff from Shannon Airport, Ireland. All 83 passengers and crew are killed.
- 1932 — The New York City Subway's third competing subway system, the municipally owned IND, is opened.
- 1976 — A British Airways Hawker Siddeley Trident and an Inex-Adria DC-9 collide near Zagreb, Yugoslavia, killing 176.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 2008 — The Large Hadron Collider at CERN, described as the biggest scientific experiment in history, is powered up in Geneva, Switzerland.
- 2002 — Switzerland, traditionally a neutral country, becomes a full member of the United Nations.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1967 — The people of Gibraltar vote to remain a British dependency rather than becoming part of Spain.
- 1937 — Nine nations attend the Nyon Conference to address international piracy in the Mediterranean Sea.

- 1976 — TWA Flight 355 is hijacked by five Croatian nationalists. The hijackers surrender upon landing in Paris.

A peek at tomorrow

Day 254 of the year, 111 days left in 2026. Today Battle of Tendra Day (Russia); Christian feast days: Blessed Francesco Bonifacio; Christian feast days: Blessed Bonaventura Gran; Christian feast days: Deiniol. Star sign Virgo, birthstone Sapphire.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1977 — Matthew Stevens, Welsh snooker player
- 1958 — Roxann Dawson, American actress and director
- 1968 — Paul Mayeda Berges, American director and screenwriter
- 1928 — Earl Holliman, American actor (died 2024)
- 1950 — Amy Madigan, American actress
- 1940 — Brian De Palma, American director, producer, and screenwriter
- 1930 — Cathryn Damon, American actress and dancer (died 1987)
- 1923 — Betsy Drake, American actress (died 2015)

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1991 — Continental Express Flight 2574 crashes in Colorado County, Texas, near Eagle Lake, killing 11 passengers and three crew.
- 1990 — A Faucett Boeing 727 disappears in the Atlantic Ocean while being flown from Malta to Peru.
- 1976 — A bomb planted by a Croatian terrorist, Zvonko Bušić, is found at New York's Grand Central Terminal; one NYPD officer is killed trying to defuse it.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 1997 — After a nationwide referendum, Scotland votes to establish a devolved parliament within the United Kingdom.
- 2011 — A dedication ceremony is held at the United States National September 11 Memorial on the 10th anniversary of the September 11 attacks in New York City, and the memorial opens to family members.

Coming to cinemas

SEPTEMBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 11	Resident Evil reboot
FRI 18	The Black Phone 2
FRI 25	Tron: Ares (+ IMAX)
OCTOBER 2026 • PREVIEW	
FRI 16	Untitled Christopher McQuarrie thriller
FRI 23	Frankenstein (del Toro)

11 — FORWARD PLANNING • SPORT

On the sporting calendar